

School: Swanton Morley VC Primary School. **Date:** 21/09/23

Report: DPE Onsite audit walk **DPE consultant:** Stuart Lee (SL) **School:** Matt Richards (HT) and Joanne Wilton

An onsite visit took place on 21 September 2023. This was arranged to complete a physical afterschool audit of the school. The audit walk supports the school with identifying improvements and mitigating data protection, cyber and information data risks.

Classrooms, offices and work spaces were inspected. Folders and online systems are used for sharing data securely. CPOMS is used for Safeguarding; key code secure entry was in place; CCTV was in operation; secure photocopier codes and shredding bins were being used.

Generally good practice was observed. Considerations also need to be allowed for the fact that some staff members were still working at the time of the audit walk.

The audit walk observations and recommendations have been detailed below:

Visitors sign in

Observations:

No visitor privacy information was detailed on the system/book when signing in.

A dual paper sign in system is used and the main sign in book had visitor sign in information from the start of the school year.

Information pertaining to professional visitors could be observed by parents/other visitors.

Recommendations:

- Add the following statement to the visitor sign in system: Visitor information is collected for health and safety, record of official visits and safeguarding. If you would like to know more, the general/visitors privacy notice is available on the Trust/school website, or you can ask at reception for a paper copy. More guidance regarding visitor sign in systems is available [here](#).
- Revert to a single page sign in system (A5) rather than having a book and single sheet sign in. The school can still use a sheet when parents are signing in for events etc.

Note: the school is investigating an electronic visitor sign in system for example: digigreet or similar.

External doors and entrances

Observations: external doors were secured and key code access was in place.

CCTV System

Observations:

Lack of signage where some CCTV cameras were located.

Camera view range extended across a public area (road and field)

No CCTV policy or extraction/access logs.

Recommendations:

- Add additional signage as required.
- Review with the CCTV operator the range of the camera facing the road/car park to ensure there is no invasion of members of the public's privacy.
- Adopt DPEs model CCTV policy and documentation
- Update the Data Protection Policy to include CCTV.

Link to [DPEs CCTV best practice area and supporting documents](#). SL can support at the next remote meeting.

Server room/CCTV room

Observations:

The server is positioned in a secure room.

The CCTV monitor/system is located in the same room.

Recommendations:

- Refer to the CCTV system section above.

Reception/front office(s)

Observations: Positive observation with a clear desk policy being observed. Areas were clear of clutter.

Recommendation:

- Refer to the visitor sign in system section above.

Medical room

Observations: Assessment/intervention folder observed in the work area.

Recommendation: Add to appropriate secure storage at the end of the school day.

Staffroom(s)

Observations: Positive observation. Confidential bins used and positioned in this area.

Hall

Observations: Positive observation.

Classrooms/IT room/corridors

Observations:

Classrooms were generally tidy with some lacking secure storage.

There was a lack of consistency for using forename only and full name.

Learning plan observed in open drawer.

List with full names, DOB, gender, contact details etc.

Attendance records with full names, DOB, gender and SEND etc.

Unlocked laptop.

Swimming lists with full names.

Staff ID badge on desktop.

Folder with restorative intervention of leavers (outdated).

Administration of medicines forms and medicine/inhaler (staff members still working so had not had the opportunity to put away).

Paths UN and PWs (not able to access sensitive information).

Sumdog UN and PWs.

Recommendations:

- Review [Physical Security Policy](https://dataprotection.education/best-practice-library/documents/procedures/146-dpe-model-physical-security-policy) (<https://dataprotection.education/best-practice-library/documents/procedures/146-dpe-model-physical-security-policy>).
- Continue to raise staff awareness pertaining to processing and storing sensitive data including developing end of day routines to store securely. Check out DPEs [quick reference guide](#) that can be shared with staff. In addition, [drip feed posters](#) can be displayed to support raising awareness.
- Review and implement additional training for staff as appropriate.
- Identify where full name is not needed i.e. coat pegs/lists and revert to forename only where possible. Where lists are printed for display, avoid having sensitive information included i.e. SEND, DOB etc.
- Remind staff to secure ID badges appropriately.
- Remind staff to lock desktops/laptops when not in their work area (Windows +L).
- Develop a retention schedule and encourage staff to self regulate and destroy information of leavers in folders no longer needed. Refer to [DPEs record management best practice area](#) for additional guidance.

Note: Usernames and passwords were observed and on discussion the school confirmed there was no risk to accessing sensitive data from these (although you can still access personal information). The school should be mindful of the risks and as a general rule and best practice, usernames and passwords would not be written down. Where names were included with usernames and passwords in the IT room, the school can minimise by having a forename only.

General follow ups:

- Action recommendations from the walk including adopting a consistent approach to lists i.e. forename only unless there is a teaching and learning justification. Folders can use full names although folders should be stored appropriately and checked regularly to ensure data is accurate and up to date.
- Continue to raise staff awareness and align practice with policy documentation.
- Review staff training completed and any additional training requirements for individual staff members.
- Develop and communicate the school's retention schedule.